

Abandoning Anger

Dosasutta (Iti 2)

Vuttañhetam bhagavatā vuttamarahatāti me sutam:

“Ekadhammam, bhikkhave, pajahatha; aham vo pāṭibhogo anāgāmitāya. Katamm ekadhammam? Dosam, bhikkhave, ekadhammam pajahatha; aham vo pāṭibhogo anāgāmitāyā”ti.

This was said by the Blessed One, said by the Arahant, as I have heard:

"Monks, abandon one thing; I guarantee you the state of non-returning. Which one thing? Monks, abandon anger; I guarantee you the state of non-returning."

Etamattham bhagavā avoca. Tatthetam iti vuccati:

The Blessed One said this. In this connection, this was said:

“Yena dosena duṭṭhāse, sattā gacchanti duggatiṃ; Tam dosam sammadaññāya, pajahanti vipassino; Pahāya na punāyanti, imam lokam kudācanam”ti.

"Defiled by which anger, beings go to a state of misery; fully understanding that anger, those with insight abandon it. Having abandoned it, they never return to this world again."

Ayampi attho vutto bhagavatā, iti me sutanti.

Dutiyam.

This matter too was spoken by the Blessed One, as I have heard.

(Second)

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
dosa	dosa	anger; aversion	Abandoning Anger	One of the three root defilements (<i>kilesa</i>), manifesting as aversion, anger, ill-will, or hatred.
anāgāmitā	anāgāmitā	non-returning	Abandoning Anger	The third of the four stages of liberation, where one has eradicated anger and sensual desire, ensuring they will not be reborn in the sensual world.
pāṭibhoga	pāṭibhoga	guarantor; surety	Abandoning Anger	Used by the Buddha to show his complete confidence that abandoning anger leads to the stage of non-returning.
vipassin	vipassin	one with insight	Abandoning Anger	A Vipassana practitioner; one who sees things as they really are, observing the nature of impermanence (<i>anicca</i>).

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
duggati	duggati	state of misery; bad destination	Abandoning Anger	A lower realm of suffering where beings are reborn due to unwholesome actions driven by defilements like anger.

Translator Notes

1. **Aversion as Anger (*Dosa*):** While *dosa* is often translated as anger, in the Vipassana tradition it represents the entire spectrum of aversion—from mild dislike and irritation to intense hatred and anger—arising in response to unpleasant sensations.
2. **Guarantor (*Pāṭibhoga*):** The Buddha guarantees (*pāṭibhoga*) the state of non-returning (*anāgāmitā*) to anyone who completely eradicates anger, as *dosa* is one of the lower fetters (*sarṇyojana*) that binds a being to the sensual realm.
3. **Seeing with Insight (*Vipassino*):** The verse highlights that only those who see clearly (*vipassino*, Vipassana meditators) can fully understand the nature of anger and abandon it. Insight is developed by observing the physical sensations associated with anger without reacting.